

Everywhere you go...

...always take your data with you

Your office may be where your workstation is, but 'work' may just happen someplace else—in the car, on the plane, or at the dinner table. Laptops, stacks of fragile CDs and redundant floppies can be the way to go, but not in the longshot... floppies are almost defunct, with their miniscule space and inherent frailty.

CDs are better, but be careful not to scratch, drop, or handle them with any amount of clumsiness.

Enter stage right, portable storage devices—thumb drives and external hard drives. They're portable, reliable and self sufficient, doing away with peripherals such as floppy drives and CD-ROM drives. With the availability of better and faster interfaces such as USB 2.0 and FireWire, the data transfer speeds have greatly improved. Here we pit the best available against each other and help you decide which one is a perfect match for your requirements.

There are different types of drives that are made to suit various needs. Thumb drives may have low capacities, but they are reliable and extremely portable. You can just pop one into your pocket, and have all your urgent data within easy access. Portable hard drives, on the other hand, have oodles of space, but aren't really as portable as the name suggests. These are good for backing up or transferring large amounts of data between two PCs—such as between your home and office.



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